



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Policy for the Management of Policies and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0 Introduction

Policies and standard operating procedures (SOPs) are important components in the Jamaica Constabulary Force’s (JCF’s) toolbox. They provide guidelines on the organization's standards and communicate directions and protocols in keeping with laws, regulations, and best practices. Members should read, understand, and apply policies and SOPs to optimize the combined efforts between individual performance and the organization's mandate.

This Policy for the Management of Policies and Standard Operating Procedures outlines the structure for managing policies and SOPs within the JCF. More specifically, this policy is designed to ensure consistency in the structure of policies and SOPs and how they are to be managed throughout their lifecycle.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of the Policy for the Management of Policies and Standard Operating Procedures is to ensure standardization and uniformity in the development, review, amendment, control, promulgation, distribution, restriction of access, evaluation, storage, archiving, retrieval, and disposal of all policies and SOPs in the JCF.

3.0 Scope

This Policy for the Management of Policies and Standard Operating Procedures applies to all sworn and unsworn members of the JCF and its auxiliary. It covers the agreed structure and lifecycle management of policies and SOPs, including their development, review, amendment, control, promulgation, distribution, access, restriction, evaluation, approval, storage, archiving, retrieval, and disposal.

4.0 Policy Statement

It is the policy of the JCF that all policies and/or SOPs should be developed, reviewed, amended, controlled, promulgated, distributed, accessed, stored, rescinded, evaluated, archived, retrieved, and disposed of in a consistent manner in accordance with this policy and SOPs.

5.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

ACP	Assistant Commissioner of Police
DCP	Deputy Commissioner of Police
ICTD	Information, Communication & Technology Division
IPROB	Inspectorate and Professional Standards Oversight Bureau
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
MDIS	Master Document Index System
LAD	Legal Affairs Division
PDF	Portable Document Format
PMU	Policy Management Unit
PRDB	Planning, Research and Development Branch
QMS	Quality Management System

6.0 Definitions

The following definitions should be adopted for this policy and SOP:

- 6.1 Biennially

This is the duration between the review of force-wide policies and/or SOPs, which is every two (2) years.
- 6.2 Document Controlling

This involves the development, approval, reviewing, amendment, version controlling and archiving of documents used within the JCF Quality Management System (QMS).
- 6.3 Force-wide policies and/or SOPs

These are policies and/or SOPs that apply to the general membership and are utilised in their daily policing functions.
- 6.4 JCF Document Control Procedures Request Form

This form is used to request the development, review, amendment, and rescinding of policies/or SOPs, manuals, and forms.

- 6.5 **JCF Documents Dashboard**
This is an internet-based access portal that stores all current versions of JCF policies and/or SOPs, manuals, and forms.

- 6.6 **Manual**
This is a guidebook incorporating several related policies and/or SOPs on a specified topic.

- 6.7 **Master Document Index System**
This is a database application designed to provide system security, access integrity, and effective storage, retrieval, tracking, and management of all current policies, SOPs, manuals, and forms used by the JCF.

- 6.8 **Obsolete Policies and/or SOPs, Manuals and Forms**
These are policies, SOPs, manuals, and forms that are no longer active and have become inoperable within the JCF.

- 6.9 **Process Owner**
The individual accountable for the efficacy of the document (Policy, SOP's or Manual).

- 6.10 **Promulgation/Distribution**
This is the process of making current policies and SOPs available to the membership.

- 6.11 **Consultation**
This is where PRDB engages a process owner and stakeholders in the development, review, or amendment of policies and SOPs

- 6.12 **Support Formations (SFs) Policy and/or SOPs and Manual**
These are policies and/or SOPs and manuals that apply to a specific formation's operations

- 6.13 **Triennially**
This is the duration between the review of support formation's policies and/or SOPs, which is three (3) years.

7.0 **Responsibilities**

The following summarises key responsibilities:

- 7.1 **The Commissioner of Police or a designate has the responsibility for:**
 - 7.1.1 the approval of force-wide policies and/or SOPs, and manuals;
 - 7.1.2 establishing the relevance/significance of a request for the development of policies and/or SOPs, and where it is considered appropriate, mandates ACP PRDB to conduct a preliminary examination of the proposal and;
 - 7.1.3 assessing the internal stakeholder(s) request for policies and/or SOPs and approving them where applicable.

- 7.2 **Portfolio Officers** are responsible for approving all policies and/or SOPs relating to their respective commands.

- 7.3 **The Assistant Commissioner of Police in charge of the Administration Branch** is responsible for the:
 - 7.3.1 promulgation of approved, policies and/or SOPs and manuals; and
 - 7.3.2 disposal of policies and/or SOPs and manuals.

- 7.4 **The Assistant Commissioner of Police, PRDB,** has the responsibility for:
 - 7.4.1 developing, reviewing, storing, and amendment of all force-wide policies and/or SOPs, and manuals (**see Appendices 1 & 2**);
 - 7.4.2 conducting preliminary examinations of the proposal for the development of policies and/or SOPs;

- 7.4.3 overseeing and guiding the process of the development, reviewing, and amending of support formations policies and/or SOPs;
 - 7.4.4 conducting research, stakeholder/process owner consultation in order to gather relevant information for the development, reviewing/amendment of policies and/or SOPs;
 - 7.4.5 the circulating of draft policies and/or SOPs to the relevant process owner/stakeholder for feedback or iteration(s) until a final document is produced;
 - 7.4.6 submitting final force-wide policies and/or SOPs to High Command or a designee for approval;
 - 7.4.7 ensuring that policies and/or SOPs, manuals, and forms are document-controlled;
 - 7.4.8 submitting all approved force-wide policies and/or SOPs to the ACP Administration Branch for promulgation in the weekly Force Orders;
 - 7.4.9 submitting promulgated policies and/or SOPs and forms to the Superintendent of Police Information, Communications and Technology Division (ICTD) for distribution through the JCF AllStaff email;
 - 7.4.10 maintaining an editable version of all published policies and/or SOPs for the purpose of reviews and/or amendments;
 - 7.4.11 maintaining a system within which information on all policies and/or SOPs, manuals, and related forms are recorded;
 - 7.4.12 making request of the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Superintendent of Police (ICTD), for the retrieval of archived policies and/or SOPs and manuals;
 - 7.4.13 ensuring that access control of the PRDB's server and related folders is instituted at different levels;
 - 7.4.14 causing evaluation to be conducted on policies and/or SOPs to establish compliance, as well as those that may pose a risk to the JCF's Quality Management System (QMS); and
 - 7.4.15 reviewing and/or amending policies and/or SOPs as scheduled, on request, or due to operational, administrative, or legislative changes or any deficiencies in these existing documents.
- 7.5 **The Assistant Commissioner of Police, Training Branch**, is responsible for ensuring that Force-wide policies and/or SOPs are incorporated into all training curricula.
- 7.6 **Divisional Commanders** should ensure that all members under their command are trained, retrained, and sensitised on all Force-wide policies and/or SOPs.
- 7.7 **The Superintendent of Police Information, Communications and Technology Division (ICTD)** is responsible for:
- 7.7.1 overseeing the process of storage, archiving, retrieval, and restriction of access of all electronic versions of policies and/or SOPs, and manuals;
 - 7.7.2 the repository for storing and backing up of the supporting folders on the PRDB's server.
 - 7.7.3 archiving all policies and/or SOPs and manuals that have been made obsolete, in collaboration with ACP PRDB; and
 - 7.7.4 retrieving archived policies and/or SOPs and manuals at the request from High Command or ACP PRDB.
- 7.8 **The Director, Legal Affairs Division (LAD)** has the responsibility for ensuring that policies and/or SOPs that are the subject of legislation are in conjunction with the enactment or amendment of the laws of Jamaica.

8.0 Standard Operating Procedures

The management of all policies and/or SOPs within the JCF should be treated in accordance with the following:

- 8.1 **Request for the development of Force-wide Policies and/or SOPs**
 - 8.1.1 The process flow for developing Force-wide policies and/or SOPs may be initiated by a person or entity internal or external to the JCF, by completing and submitting the request form. **(see Appendix 3 JCF Document Control Procedures Request Form)**

- 8.1.2 Where the request for the development of a policy or SOP originates outside of the JCF, it should be addressed to the Commissioner of Police. The Commissioner of Police may consider the request and, where deemed appropriate, mandate ACP PRDB to conduct a preliminary assessment of the proposal and recommend a course of action.

8.2 **Development of Policies and/ or SOPs**

The development of policies and/or SOPs should be done in the following manner:

8.2.1 **Force-wide**

- a. Research should be conducted by the Policy Management Unit (PMU) to gather relevant information for the development of force-wide policies and/or SOPs, along with process owner/stakeholder consultation.
- b. PRDB consults with the process owner and stakeholders to gather relevant information to assist in the development process.
- c. The PMU should prepare a draft policy and/or SOPs and circulate them to the relevant process owners and stakeholders for feedback until a final document is produced.
- d. The document is sent to DCP FDLP for approval. Where it has not been approved, further consultation with the process owner and stakeholders should be conducted until the policy or SOP is approved.

NB. Policies and SOPs should be drafted using simple, unambiguous language that directs members' actions adequately.

8.2.2 **Support Formations**

- a. Formation Commanders should develop policies and/or SOPs that are relevant to their operations.
- b. A draft of the policy and/or SOPs should be submitted to the ACP PRDB, where the PMU should guide the process of developing the policy and/or SOPs.
- c. PRDB should send the document to the process owner for approval. Where the document has not been approved, further consultation should be conducted with the process owner and stakeholders until the policy or SOP is approved.

8.2.3 **Structure of Policies and Standard Operating Procedures**

All policies and/or SOPs (force-wide and support formation) should comprise the following sections:

a) **Introduction**

This should contain, *inter alia*, an opening statement providing background information and a summary of the issues the policy and/or SOPs should address.

b) **Purpose**

A statement outlining specific goals of the policy and SOPs

c) **Scope**

It is a descriptive statement outlining the parameters of the policy and/or SOPs, including its deliverables and a list of process owners/stakeholders who may be affected or impacted.

d) **Policy Statement**

All policies should have at least one, or at best, a series of interconnected and interrelated statements that should, among other things, identify and outline the organisation or department's guiding principles, position, and

values on the particular matter. The statement(s) should serve to influence decisions and actions that are prudent, practical, or advantageous to the organisation, the department, and the process owner/stakeholder.

e) **Abbreviations and Acronyms**

Where shortened forms of keywords are used throughout the policy and SOPs, a list should be included to aid readers' comprehension.

f) **Definitions**

Where specific words, concepts, or terms are used, there should be a 'Definition of Terms' to assist in understanding, interpreting, and evaluating within the context of how they apply to the policy and/or SOPs.

g) **Responsibilities**

Distinct statement(s) summarising the responsibilities that include identifying specific tasks of persons vital to the operationalization of the policy and/or SOPs.

h) **Standard Operating Procedures**

This is a written step-by-step instruction to guide members in executing specific tasks in a prescribed manner, which should bolster efficiency, quality output, and uniformity of performance.

i) **References**

Where appropriate, all policies and SOPs should contain a list of references within which they should operate. An approved scholarly referencing format should be included in all policies and/or SOPs.

j) **Relevant Forms**

Where the policy and/or SOPs require the use of forms, they should be referenced and appended. Forms are to be controlled using the unique Identification Code outlined in this document.

k) **Relevant Records**

Where the policy and/or SOPs require the use of records, they should be referenced and appended thereto.

NB. Where a form, template, or other record(s) cannot be published along with the relevant policy and/or SOPs, it should be distributed by JCF AllStaff.

8.3 **Reviewing and/or Amendment of Policies and/or SOPs and Manuals**

8.3.1 All Policies, SOPs, and manuals may be reviewed and amended due to changes in operation, administrative, or legislative changes, the document reaches its life-cycle or any deficiencies in existing documents.

8.3.2 PRDB, the process owner or stakeholder identifies the policy, SOP, and Manual to be reviewed/amended.

8.3.3 PRDB informs the process owner and stakeholder, or the process owner or stakeholder advises PRDB, that the document is required to be reviewed/amended, as outlined in **section 8.3.1**.

8.3.4 The PRDB/process owner/stakeholder should complete the JCF Document Control Procedures Request Form, outlining the request(s) to the ACP PRDB.

8.3.5 PRDB consults with the process owner and stakeholders to gather relevant information to assist in the review and/or amendment process. Procedures outlined in **Section 8.2.1 (c-d)** should apply.

NB. Where policies, SOPs, and manuals are reviewed and no amendments are required, the banner should be updated accordingly.

8.4 **Approval of Policies and/or SOPs and Manuals**

- 8.4.1 The High Command or a designee should approve all force-wide policies and/or SOPs.
- 8.4.2 Approved Force-wide policies, SOPs and manuals should be sent to ACP Administration and Support Services Branch for promulgation in Force Orders or JCF AllStaff.
- 8.4.3 The Heads of Portfolios or a designee should approve all policies and/or SOPs for formations within their respective commands.
- 8.4.4 Approved Support Formation policies, SOPs and manuals should be sent to the process owner for distribution within the formation.

8.5 **Version Controlling**

- 8.5.1 Approved policies and/or SOPs and manuals are to be document-controlled. *(see Appendix 4: Process Flow for the Version Controlling of Documents).*
- 8.5.2 All Policies and/or SOPs, Manuals, and Forms should be assigned a unique Identification Code (see **Appendix 5:** diagram outlining Identification Code). Identification Codes should be generated **ONLY** by the ACP PRDB and should be constructed in the following manner:
 - 1. Begin with the organisation's abbreviation (Jamaica Constabulary Force) – **'JCF'**
 - 2. For policies or SOPs applicable to:
 - a. general membership (Force-wide), add – **'FW'**
 - b. a specific Formation, insert the formation's abbreviation, for example, **'TechBranch'** for *Technology Branch*.
 - c. the unit/section within a specific formation's abbreviation, for example, **'TechBranch-ICTD'** for *Information and Communication Technology Division*.
- 8.5.3 A policy should be denoted by – **'PL'** (This also applies where an SOP is attached to the Policy)
- 8.5.4 Standard Operating Procedures should be denoted by – **'PR'** (where this is a stand-alone SOP)
- 8.5.5 Manual should be denoted by – **'MAN'**
- 8.5.6 Policies and procedures are divided into six categories and are denoted as follows: Administration and Welfare (**Adm**), Operations (**Ops**), Management (**Mgt**), Crime and Security (**C&S**), General Procedures (**Gen**) and Support Formations (**SFs**)
- 8.5.7 Add a 4-digit sequential number indicating the number of policies or SOPs developed within the year, followed by the year in which they were developed.
- 8.5.8 Where an SOP requires completing a **Form**, the **Form** should be denoted by – **'F'** and its sequential number. **Example:** F01.
- 8.5.9 Each component of the Identification Code should be separated by a forward slash '/'. **For example, JCF/FW/Ops/0001/2021/F01**

NB. The pagination of all policies and SOPs should be in the form 'page x of y', with 'x' being the sequentially numbered page and 'y' the total number of pages (including appendices, endnotes, etc.) in the document.

8.6 **Promulgation and Distribution of Force-wide Policies and/or SOPs and Forms**

The following outlines the procedure for the promulgation and distribution of force-wide policies and/or SOPs and forms:

8.6.1 **Force Orders Promulgation**

All approved policies and/or SOPs should be submitted to the ACP Administration Branch for promulgation in the weekly Force Orders.

8.6.2 **AllStaff Distribution**

When policies and/or SOPs, and forms have been promulgated, a copy should be sent to the Superintendent of Police ICTD, for distribution through the JCF's AllStaff email.

8.7 Storage and Archiving of all Policies and/or SOPs and Manuals

The following applies to the storing and archiving of policies and/or SOPs, manuals and forms:

8.7.1 The PRDB's server that houses all Policies, SOP's and Manuals should be access-controlled and backed up for security, restriction and retrieval.

8.7.2 All obsolete policies, SOPs, and manuals should be kept for five (5) years before being sent to ICTD for archiving.

NB: Policies and/or SOPs, manuals, and forms should become obsolete when a new version is published.

8.8 Retrieval of Archived Force-wide Policies and/or SOPs and Manuals

Where a policy and/or SOPs or manual that has been archived is being requested, the request should be submitted to the ICTD for its retrieval. All retrieval should be authorised.

8.9 Restriction of Editing to current Policies and/or SOPs and Manuals

Current policies and/or SOPs and manuals should be restricted from being edited in the following manner:

8.9.1 All promulgated and distributed policies and SOPs should be in Portable Document Format (PDF).

8.9.2 Access control of the PRDB's server should be instituted to secure and restrict access to all policies, SOPs, and manuals.

8.10 Master Document Index System

A Master Document Index System should be developed and maintained, within which information on all JCF policies and/or SOPs, manuals, and related forms is recorded.

8.10.1 The Master Document Index System should contain *inter alia* the following information: Name of Document; Identification Code; Classification; Category; Distribution; Status; Last Force Orders Publication Number; Effective by; Date of Last Review; Number of Revisions; Due for Next Review; process owner(s); JCF Document Control Procedures Request Form.

8.10.2 Status of policies, SOPs, manuals, and related forms is broken down into three subtitles:

a. **Current** – This is when a policy, SOPs, and/or forms are active and do not require review/amendment.

b. **Under Review** – This is when a policy and or SOPs are being reviewed because of expiration, or a request is made for amendment.

c. **Awaiting Approval** - This is when a policy and/or SOPs are sent to the authorized person for approval.

8.10.3 The Master Document Index System is updated upon the promulgation and/or distribution of developed, reviewed and/or amended policies, SOPs, or manuals.

8.11 Access to Policies, SOPs and Manuals by Members and External Stakeholders

Policies, SOPs and manuals may be accessible to members and external stakeholders in the following manner:

8.11.1 Members may access current Policies, SOPs and Manuals through the JCF Document Dashboard (JCF Docs). Members are required to register to this platform to gain access.

8.11.2 The JCF Docs is updated upon the promulgation and/or distribution of developed, reviewed and/or amended policies, SOPs, or manuals.

8.11.3 External stakeholders may be given authorised access to read-only versions of policies and SOPs by making an application to the Commissioner of Police, which is coordinated through ACP PRDB.

8.12 **Evaluation of Policies, SOPs and Manuals**

8.12.1 An evaluation should be conducted of policies and/or SOPs that may pose a risk to the JCF QMS, as well as to establish compliance by members.

8.12.2 Evaluation of policies and/or SOPs should be conducted on the directive of the High Command.

8.13 **Legal Assessment of Policy, SOPs and Manuals**

Where policies and/or SOPs are developed, reviewed, or amended and are the subject of Legislation, they should be sent to the Director of the Legal Affairs Division (LAD) for assessment and to solicit feedback.

8.14 **Disposal of Archived Policies and/or SOPs and Manuals**

Archived policies and/or SOPs, manuals, and forms should be disposed of in accordance with JCF guidelines.

9.0 References

This JCF Policy for the Management of Policies and Standard Operating Procedures should be read in conjunction with:

9.1 Access to Information Act (2002)

9.2 The Data Protection Act (2020)

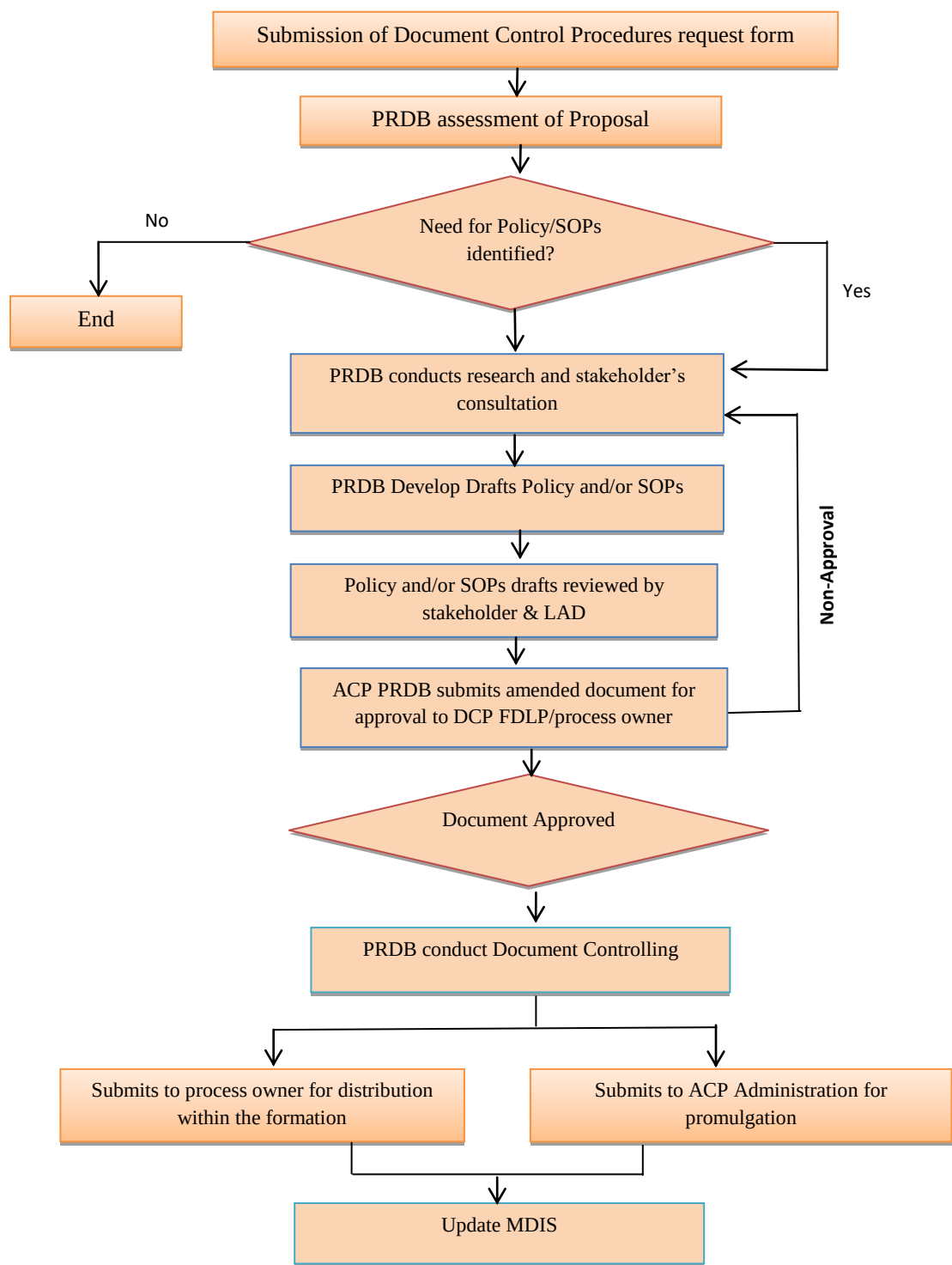
10.0 Relevant Form

10.1 **(Appendix 3):** JCF Document Control Procedures Request Form

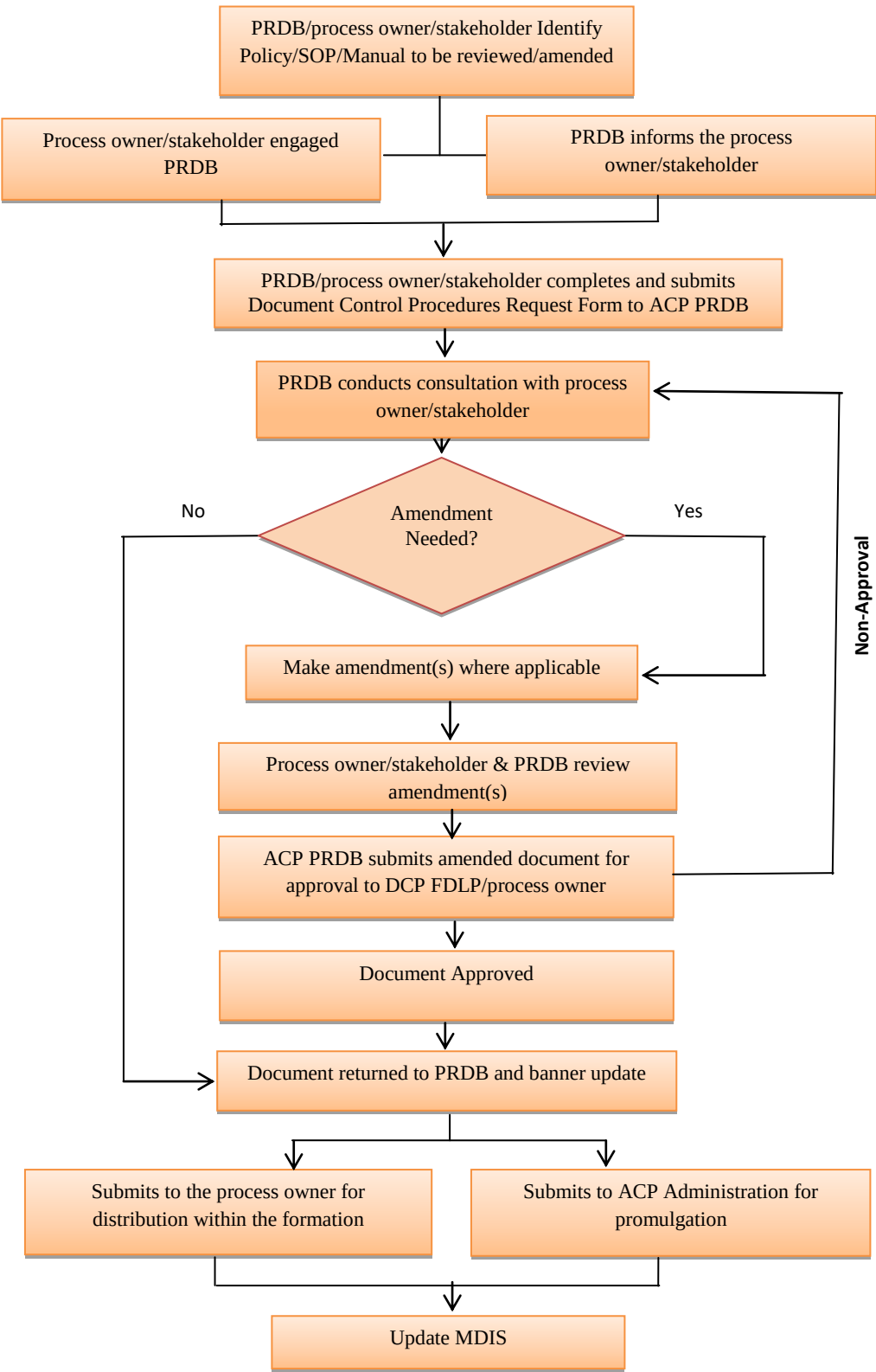
11.0 Relevant Record

11.1 Master Document Index System

Appendix 1: Process Flow for the Development of Policy and/or SOPs



Appendix 2: Process Flow for the Reviewing and/or Amending of Policy and/or SOPs



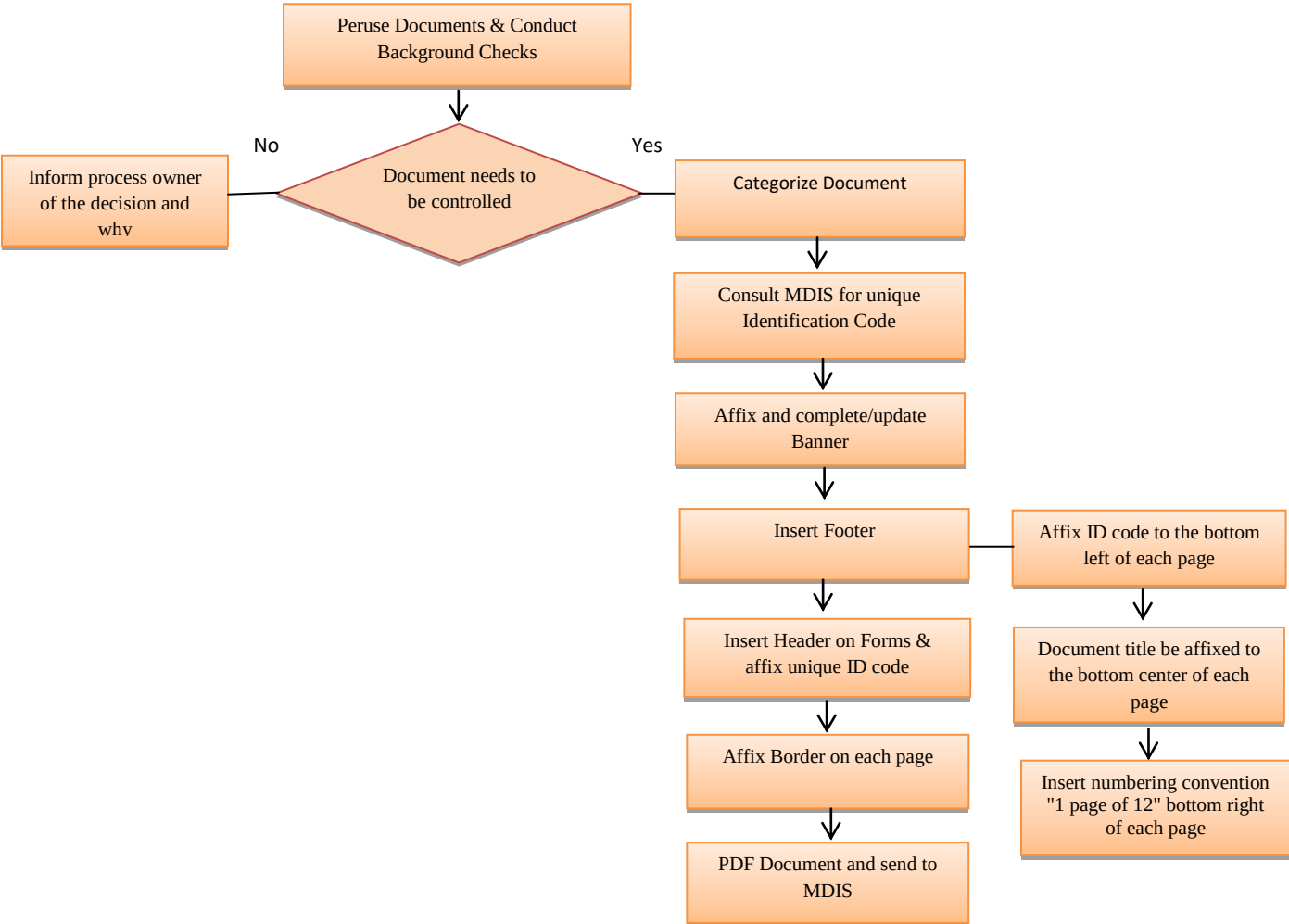


Date of request: _____

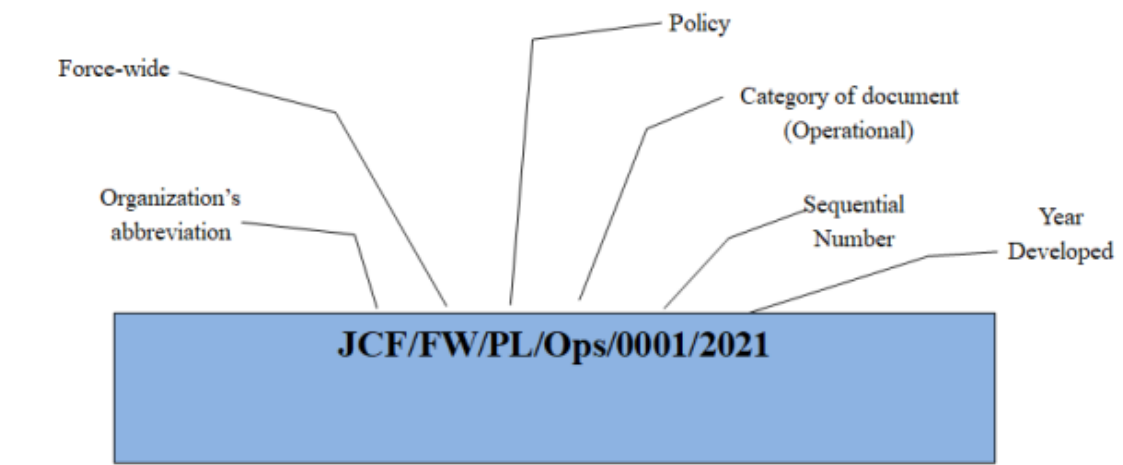
Formation or person Making Request: _____

Policy/SOPs/Manual/Form Information <i>(Complete section where applicable)</i>	
Name of Policy/SOPs/Manual/Form:	Policy/SOPs/Manual/Form #:
Date and Number of Last Force Order Promulgation: _____ Date of Last AllStaff Distribution: _____ Approved Date (process owner): _____	
Reason(s) for Request: _____	
Section(s) of Document to be Reviewed/Amended: _____	
Accompanying Document(s): Yes ☐ No ☐ Name of Document(if yes): _____	
FOR INTERNAL USE (PRDB Policy Unit)	
Director PMU	
Date of Assessment: _____	
Recommended ☐ Not Recommended ☐ Comment (if any): _____	
Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____ YYYY/MM/DD	
ACP PRDB	
Approved ☐ Not Approved ☐ Comment(s): _____	
Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____ YYYY/MM/DD	

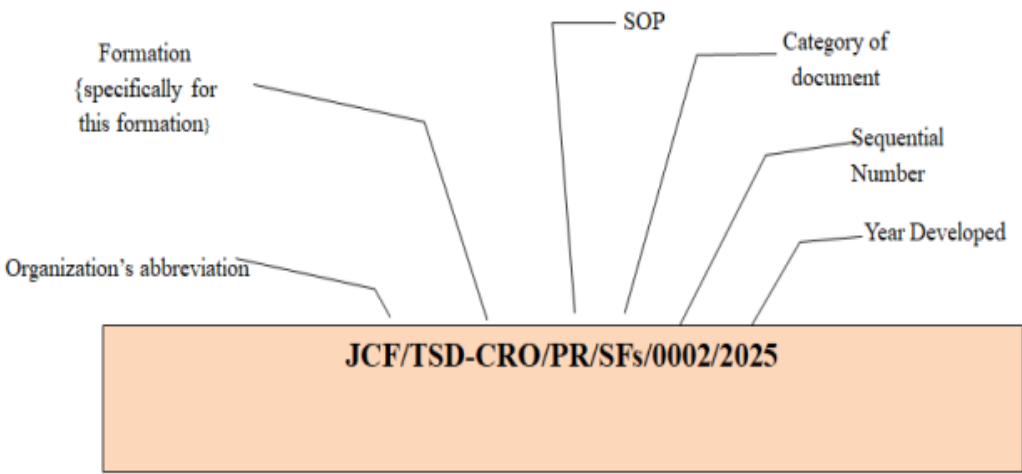
Appendix 4: Process Flow for the Version Controlling of Documents



Policy Identification (Force Wide)



SOP Identification (Formation Specific)



Form Identification

